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United States Patent	12406636
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 02, 2025
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Display panel

Abstract

The invention provides a display panel, comprising: a substrate having a peripheral area and a display area adjacent to each other, the display area provided with a plurality of pixel units; a gate driving unit provided in the peripheral area; a connection unit provided between the gate driving unit and the display area, and electrically connected to the gate driving unit and the plurality of pixel unit; and a shielding unit provided on the connection unit; wherein a projection area of the connection unit on the substrate corresponds to a projection area of the shielding unit on the substrate, and the shielding unit is electrically connected to a fixed potential.

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Appl. No.:	18/274628
Filed (or PCT Filed):	May 24, 2022
PCT No.:	PCT/CN2022/094616
PCT Pub. No.:	WO2023/193329
PCT Pub. Date:	October 12, 2023

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20250087178 A1	Mar. 13, 2025

Foreign Application Priority Data

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G09G3/36 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC G09G3/3677 (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: G09G (3/3677)

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

1. Field of the Invention

(1) The disclosure relates to a display panel, and particularly to a narrow bezel display panel.

2. Related Art

(2) With development of science and technology, the display panel is widely applied to many electronic products, such as, mobile phones, tablet computers, watches, and the like.

(3) In the existing display panel, the demand for narrow bezels becomes stronger, such that conversion connection between gate driving circuits and pixel units is closer to a display area. If contact holes among different metal layers are used to achieve the conversion connection, a layer of mask and a making procedure will be added, necessarily causing reduction of production efficiency and improvement of cost. Generally, the contact holes are replaced by first transparent conductive layers to achieve transition between the metal layers.

(4) However, when using the first transparent conductive layer to achieve transition, since a distance between the first transparent conductive layer and the pixel unit is too close, and a voltage in the gate driving circuit is switched between 15V and -12V at each frame, the first transparent conductive layer in a transition area and a second transparent conductive layer of the pixel unit form a negative voltage electric field, and electric field effect will cause the originally arranged liquid crystals to redirect, causing light leakage due to incomplete redirection of the liquid crystals or no response of the redirection, and then easily producing bright spots on long edges of the display panel.

(5) Therefore, how to provide a display panel that is made conveniently and can avoid bright spots produced on long edges is actually one of the problems to be solved.

SUMMARY

(6) The embodiments of the invention provide a display panel, which can better avoid light leakage and bright spots produced, and improve display quality and yield of the products on the basis of reducing the production cost and decreasing the making procedure.

(7) In one embodiment of the invention, a display panel comprises: a substrate having a peripheral area and a display area adjacent to each other, the display area provided with a plurality of pixel units; a gate driving unit provided in the peripheral area; a connection unit provided between the gate driving unit and the display area, and electrically connected to the gate driving unit and the plurality of pixel units; and a shielding unit provided on the connection unit; wherein a projection area of the connection unit on the substrate corresponds to a projection area of the shielding unit on the substrate, and the shielding unit is electrically connected to a fixed potential.

(8) In the display panel, the connection unit is electrically connected to a second metal layer in the gate driving unit and a first metal layer in the plurality of pixel units.

(9) In the display panel, the plurality of pixel units include a first number of rows of pixel units, the connection unit includes a second number of connection structures, the second number is matched with the first number, and each connection structure is connected to one row of pixel units.

(10) In the display panel, the gate driving unit has a first gate driving circuit located on one side of the display area, and a second gate driving circuit located on the other side of the display area.

(11) In the display panel, the connection unit comprises a first transparent conductive layer.

(12) In the display panel, the shielding unit comprises a first portion, and a second portion covering the connection unit and comprising a second transparent conductive layer.

(13) In the display panel, the first portion is connected to a conductive layer of the peripheral area and the second portion, and the first portion comprises a first transparent conductive layer.

(14) In the display panel, the plurality of pixel units comprises a second transparent conductive layer.

(15) In the display panel, the shielding unit has a first end and a second end opposite to each other, the first end is close to the display area, the second end is close to the gate driving unit, and the first end extends towards the display area and goes beyond the connection unit.

(16) In the display panel, the second end is electrically connected to a conductive layer of the peripheral area.

(17) In the display panel, the fixed potential is low potential.

- (18) In the display panel, the low potential is earth potential or common potential.
- (19) In the display panel, the second end extends towards the gate driving unit and goes beyond the connection unit.
- (20) In the display panel of the invention, the gate driving unit is electrically connected to the plurality of pixel units through the connection unit, and by virtue of design of the shielding unit, a negative voltage electric field between the connection unit and the plurality of pixel units can be better shielded, thereby avoiding light leakage in the display area due to incomplete redirection of the liquid crystals or no response of the redirection, then avoiding bright spots produced on edges of the display panel, and improving display quality of the display panel.
- (21) Hereinafter the invention is described in details combining with the accompanying drawings and the specific embodiments, but the invention is not limited thereto.
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Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a structural diagram of a display panel in one embodiment of the invention.
- (2) FIG. 2 is a structural diagram along a section line C-C' in FIG. 1.
- (3) FIG. 3A is a structural diagram of a display panel in another embodiment of the invention.
- (4) FIG. 3B is a structural diagram along a section line C-C' in FIG. 3A.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENT

- (5) Hereinafter structure principle and working principle of the invention are described in details combining with the accompanying drawings.
- (6) FIG. 1 is a structural diagram of a display panel in one embodiment of the invention, and FIG. 2 is a structural diagram along a section line C-C' in FIG. 1. As shown in FIGS. 1 and 2, the display panel **100** of this embodiment comprises a substrate **101** having a display area AA and a peripheral area BA adjacent to each other, wherein a plurality of pixel units PX arranged in an array are formed in the display area AA; a gate driving unit **102** provided in the peripheral area BA adjacent to the display area AA; and a connection unit **103** provided between the gate driving unit **102** and the display area AA for electrically connection between the gate driving unit **102** and the plurality of pixel units PX to provide a driving signal to the plurality of pixel units PX. The display panel **100** further comprises a shielding unit **104** at a position corresponding to the connection unit **103**. In this embodiment, a projection area of the connection unit **103** on the substrate **101** at least partially overlaps a projection area of the shielding unit **104** on the substrate **101**. In order to better shield, the shielding unit **104** is electrically connected to a fixed potential. Preferably, the fixed potential is low potential, and in actual operation, the low potential may be earth potential or common potential. In actual operation, the display panel **100** further comprises a pairing substrate (not shown) and a liquid crystal layer. The substrate **100** is paired with the pairing substrate, and the liquid crystal layer is sandwiched therebetween.
- (7) In the display panel **100** of the invention, the gate driving unit **102** is electrically connected to the plurality of pixel units PX through the connection unit **103**, and by virtue of design of the shielding unit **104**, an electric field formed between the connection unit **103** and the plurality of pixel units PX is avoided to affect redirection of the liquid crystals, thereby avoiding bright spots produced on edges of the display panel **100**, and improving display quality of the display panel **100**.
- (8) In one embodiment, the plurality of plurality of pixel units PX arranged in an array include a first number of rows of pixel units PX, the display panel **100** includes a second number of connection structures **1031**, the second number is matched with the first number, such as, the first number or times of the first number, and each connection unit **103** is connected to one row of pixel units PX. In such way, the gate driving unit **102** provides a driving signal to each row of pixel units

PX by virtue of the second number of connection structures **1031**. Correspondingly, the shielding unit **104** corresponds to the connection unit **103**, and also includes the second number, and each shielding unit **104** corresponds to one connection unit **103** to shield each connection structure **1031**. In actual operation, the users also may arrange the shielding unit only for a part of the connection structures.

(9) As shown in FIG. 1, in this embodiment, the gate driving unit **102** is provided on both sides of the display area AA. That is, the gate driving unit **102** has a first gate driving circuit **1021** located on one side of the display area AA, and a second gate driving circuit **1022** located on the other side of the display area AA. The plurality of pixel units PX arranged in an array are divided into odd-numbered rows of pixel units connected to the first gate driving circuit **1021**, and even-numbered rows of pixel units connected to the second gate driving circuit **1022**. At this time, the second number equals to the first number, and the second number of connection structures **1031** includes odd-numbered levels of connection structures located between the display area AA and the first gate driving circuit **1021**, and even-numbered levels of connection structures located between the display area AA and the second gate driving circuit **1022**. Each odd-numbered level of connection structures is electrically connected to the first gate driving circuit **1021** and one odd-numbered row of pixel units, and each even-numbered level of connection structures is electrically connected to the second gate driving circuit **1022** and one even-numbered row of pixel units. Correspondingly, the second number of shielding units **104** includes odd-numbered levels of shielding units located on one side of the display area AA and even-numbered levels of shielding units located on the other side of the display area AA, each odd-numbered level of shielding units corresponds to one odd-numbered level of connection structures, and each even-numbered level of shielding units corresponds to one even-numbered level of connection structures to shield each connection structure. Similarly with the previous embodiment, in actual operation, the users also may arrange the shielding unit only for a part of connection structures.

(10) In the embodiment of FIG. 1, the first gate driving circuit **1021** is configured to drive the odd-numbered rows of pixel units, and the second gate driving circuit **1022** is configured to drive the even-numbered rows of pixel units. In actual operation, in another embodiment, the first gate driving circuit **1021** and the second gate driving circuit **1022** may be both connected to each row of pixel units PX, such that the first gate driving circuit **1021** and the second gate driving circuit **1022** may together drive each row of pixel units PX from both sides of the display area AA. At this time, the second number may equal to twice of the first number, the first number of connection structures **1031** is located between the display area AA and the first gate driving circuit **1021**, and the first number of connection structures **1031** is also located between the display area AA and the second gate driving circuit **1022**. Correspondingly, the display panel **100** has the second number of shielding units **104**, the first number of shielding units **104** is located on one side of the display area AA, the first number of shielding units **104** is also located on the other side of the display area AA, and each shielding unit corresponds to one connection structure to shield each connection structure. Similarly with the previous embodiment, in actual operation, the users also may arrange the shielding unit only for a part of connection structures.

(11) As for the display panel in other forms, the gate driving unit may be arranged on one or more sides of the display area AA, and also may be arranged surrounding the display area AA, but the invention is not limited thereto. Moreover, connection relations of the connection structure, the shielding unit, the gate driving unit and the plurality of pixel units are similar, and the details are not described here.

(12) In the invention, the connection unit **103** may be configured to connect the gate driving unit **102** and metal layers in the plurality of pixel units PX. As shown in FIG. 2, in this embodiment, the connection structure **1031** is electrically connected to a second metal layer M2 in the gate driving unit **102** and a first metal layer M1 in the plurality of pixel units PX. In actual operation, each row of pixel units PX includes a gate line, the gate line may be formed by the first metal layer M1, and

each connection structure **1031** is connected to the gate line of the corresponding row of pixel units PX. The gate driving unit **102** transmits a driving signal to the corresponding gate line via the connection structure **1031** after transmitting the driving signal to the connection structure **103** through the second metal layer M2. The connection structure **1031** is often formed by a first transparent conductive layer IT01, thereby achieving conversion connection between the first metal layer M1 and the second metal layer M2, but the invention is not limited thereto.

(13) In the invention, the shielding unit **104** may comprise a first portion **1041** and a second portion **1042**, and the second portion **1042** covers the connection structure **1031**. In this embodiment, the second portion **1042** is formed by a second transparent conductive layer IT02, such that the second portion **1042** may be covered on the connection structure **1031** formed by the first transparent conductive layer IT01 to shield the connection structure **1031**. The first portion **1041** is formed by the first transparent conductive layer IT01, and the first portion **1041** has one end connected to the second portion **1042**, and the other end connected to a conductive layer in the peripheral area BA to receive a fixed potential supplied by the conductive layer, and transfer the received fixed potential to the second portion **1042** in order to ensure the shielding effect of the second portion **1042** on the connection structure **1031**. Of course, architecture and material of the first portion **1041** and/or the second portion **1042** are not limited thereto. In actual operation, the peripheral area BA may have a metal layer, and the other end of the first portion **1041** is connected to the metal layer to receive the fixed potential. In this embodiment, the metal layer is the first metal layer M1, and in actual operation, the metal layer also may be the second metal layer M2 or formed together by the first metal layer M1 and the second metal layer M2 through bridging, but the invention is not limited thereto.

(14) Further, as shown in FIG. 2, the plurality of pixel units PX include the second transparent conductive layer ITO2. In this embodiment, the second transparent conductive layer ITO2 may act as a pixel electrode, and in order to better shield the negative voltage electric field formed between the connection structure **1031** and the second transparent conductive layer IT02 in the plurality of pixel units PX, the shielding unit **104** may completely extend beyond and cover the connection structure **1031**. That is, a projection area of the connection structure **1031** on the substrate **101** is located in a projection area of the shielding unit **104** on the substrate **101**, or the projection area of the connection structure **1031** on the substrate **101** overlaps the projection area of the shielding unit **104** on the substrate **101**. Alternatively, the shielding unit **104** at least extends beyond and covers the connection structure **1031** in a direction between the gate driving unit **102** and the display area AA. That is, in the direction between the gate driving unit **102** and the display area AA, the projection area of the connection structure **1031** on the substrate **101** is located in the projection area of the shielding unit **104** on the substrate **101**.

(15) Specifically, as shown in FIG. 2, the shielding unit **104** has a first end **1043** and a second end **1044** opposite to each other, the first end **1043** is close to the pixel area AA and extends towards the pixel area AA to go beyond the connection structure **1031**, and the second end **1044** is close to the gate driving unit **102** and extends towards the gate driving unit **102** to go beyond the connection structure **1031**. The second end **1044** of the shielding unit **104** is electrically connected to a metal layer of the peripheral area BA, and the metal layer is connected to a fixed potential. In this embodiment, the metal layer is the first metal layer M1, and in actual operation, the metal layer also may be the second metal layer M2 or formed together by the first metal layer M1 and the second metal layer M2 through bridging, but the invention is not limited thereto. Preferably, the fixed potential is low potential, and the low potential may be earth potential or common potential.

(16) FIG. 3A is a structural diagram of a display panel in another embodiment of the invention, and FIG. 3B is a structural diagram along a section line C-C' in FIG. 3A. As shown in FIGS. 3A and 3B, the substrate **101** is further provided with signal conducting wires **105**, which are between the gate driving unit **102** and the plurality of pixel units PX of the display area AA. In this embodiment, the shielding unit **104** is further covered on at least a part of the signal conducting

wires **105** adjacent to the corresponding connection structures **1031**.

(17) Specifically, as shown in FIG. 3B, the shielding unit **104** has a first end **1043** and a second end **1044** opposite to each other, the first end **1043** is close to the pixel area AA and extends towards the pixel area AA to go beyond the connection structure **1031**, the second end **1044** is close to the gate driving unit **102** and extends towards the gate driving unit **102** to go beyond the connection structure **1031**, and the second end **1044** of the shielding unit **104** is covered on at least a part of the signal conducting wires **105** adjacent to the corresponding connection structures **1031**. In this embodiment, the respective signal conducting wires **105** are formed by the first metal layers M1, but in actual operation, the invention is not limited thereto. For example, the respective signal conducting wires **105** also may be formed by the second metal layers M2, or formed together by the first metal layer M1 and the second metal layer M2 through bridging. As shown in FIG. 3B, in this embodiment, the conductive layer for providing the fixed potential to the shielding unit **104** in the peripheral area BA is formed by the first metal layer M1, and located between the signal conducting wire **105** and the display area AA, but in actual operation, the invention is not limited thereto.

(18) To sum up, according to the embodiments of the invention, since the display panel uses the shielding unit, the negative voltage electric field between the connection structure and the pixel unit can be better shielded to avoid light leakage due to incomplete redirection of the liquid crystals or no response of the redirection in the display area, thereby eliminating bright spots produced on long edges of the display panel, and improving display quality and yield of the products.

(19) Of course, the invention may further have various other embodiments, and in the case of not departing from spirit and essence of the invention, those skilled in the art shall make various corresponding modifications and variations according to the invention, but these corresponding modifications and variations shall belong to the scope of protection of the appended claims.

Industrial Applicability

(20) The display panel of the invention has the following advantageous effects: the negative voltage electric field between the connection structure and the pixel unit can be better shielded to avoid light leakage due to incomplete redirection of the liquid crystals or no response of the redirection in the display area, thereby eliminating bright spots produced on long edges of the display panel, and improving display quality and yield of the products.

REFERENCE SIGNS LIST

(21) **100**: display panel **101**: first substrate **102**: gate driving unit **1021**: first gate driving circuit **1022**: second gate driving circuit **103**: connection unit **1031**: connection structure **104**: shielding unit **1041**: first portion **1042**: second portion **1043**: first end **1044**: second end **105**: signal conducting wire AA: display area BA: peripheral area M1: first metal layer M2: second metal layer P1, BP2, PL, GI: interlayer insulating layer

Claims

1. A display panel, comprising: a substrate having a peripheral area and a display area adjacent to each other, the display area provided with a plurality of pixel units; a gate driving unit provided in the peripheral area; a connection unit provided between the gate driving unit and the display area, and electrically connected to the gate driving unit and the plurality of pixel units; and a shielding unit provided on the connection unit; and a projection area of the connection unit on the substrate corresponds to a projection area of the shielding unit on the substrate, and the shielding unit is electrically connected to a fixed potential; wherein the shielding unit has a first end and a second end opposite to each other, the first end is close to the display area, the second end is close to the gate driving unit, and the first end extends towards the display area and goes beyond the connection unit.

2. The display panel according to claim 1, wherein the connection unit is electrically connected to a

- first metal layer in the plurality of pixel unit and a second metal layer in the gate driving unit.
3. The display panel according to claim 1, wherein the plurality of pixel units include a first number of rows of pixel units, the connection unit includes a second number of connection structures, the second number is matched with the first number, and each connection structure is connected to one row of pixel units.
 4. The display panel according to claim 1, wherein the gate driving unit has a first gate driving circuit located on one side of the display area, and a second gate driving circuit located on the other side of the display area.
 5. The display panel according to claim 1, wherein the connection unit comprises a first transparent conductive layer.
 6. The display panel according to claim 1, wherein the shielding unit comprises a first portion, and a second portion covering the connection unit and comprising a second transparent conductive layer.
 7. The display panel according to claim 6, wherein the first portion is connected to a conductive layer of the peripheral area and the second portion, and the first portion comprises a first transparent conductive layer.
 8. The display panel according to claim 1, wherein the second end is electrically connected to a conductive layer of the peripheral area.
 9. The display panel according to claim 1, wherein the fixed potential is a low potential.
 10. The display panel according to claim 9, wherein the low potential is earth potential or common potential.
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